

# State of Code Developer Survey report

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# Introduction

Sonar analyzes over 750 billion lines of code each day, which gives us a unique understanding of code. This year, we kicked off a new report series called the [State of Code](#) to share some of our knowledge with developers and technology leaders more broadly.

We've already written reports on code [reliability](#), [security](#), [maintainability](#), and the [specific coding personalities of leading LLMs](#). Those reports focused primarily on the code itself and the models creating it. Next we wanted to expand that view to include the state of code from the perspective of the people doing the work—the developers writing code and collaborating with AI to build it.

Specifically, we wanted to get a read on what is changing for them. As AI rapidly shifts the mechanics of coding, we need to understand the on-the-ground reality—the efficiencies, the frustrations, and the new workflows emerging. To ensure we add real value to the industry narrative, we designed this study to build upon the findings in other leading developer surveys and to answer the pressing questions we still had after reading them.

After surveying more than 1,100 developers, we saw a critical new narrative emerging. Simply put, the explosion in AI-generated code hasn't led directly to massive and much-hyped productivity gains yet. Instead, a verification bottleneck has emerged, creating a whole new set of challenges. As we cover this and other findings, we'll explore how the AI-coding shift is manifesting across software engineering organizations across the world, and how they are adapting to address it.

## About this report

The 2026 State of Code Developer Survey was a quantitative online survey conducted among professional software developers. Fieldwork for the survey ran throughout October 2025.

The final sample size for the study included 1,149 responses, distributed globally. All respondents were 18 years or older, employed full-time or self-employed in a technology role (the vast majority worked in software engineering, with some others in fields related to IT ops, data science, or product management), write code or manage developers using at least one programming language, and have used AI as part of their job within the past year.

Further details about the report's demographic makeup are available in the appendix.